

Documentation 1: Design Sprint

Week 1 Google Design Sprint

Candidate: 9, 15,17, 30,32,35,38

Fall, 2025

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1. Introduction

We were provided with the task of making a solution for Peers: a solution where onboarding for event makers is as simple and intuitive as possible. According to the owner of Peers “Peers empower events with innovative judging technology, enhancing audience engagement and creativity for sport, competitions and awards”. In summary, Peers bring together event planning and hosting, where the audience can dynamically interact with the possibilities of voting/rating. The current process of creating an event manually:

1. The Peers home page pops up, Figure 1
2. Log in to a Peers account / make an account.
3. Click on the top left corner “Create event”.
4. Figure 2 shows up as the next step.
5. After clicking “New Peers Event” in Figure 2, Figure 3 pops up.
6. Fill in the details for each submenu of the planned event.
7. Figure 4 illustrates one of the submenus to be filled.

Figure 1: Home page after logging in. Figure 2: After logging in and clicking “Create Event”

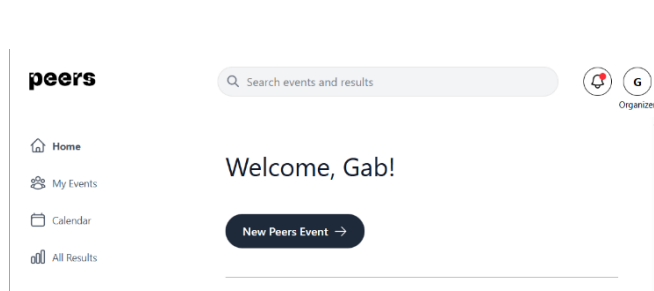
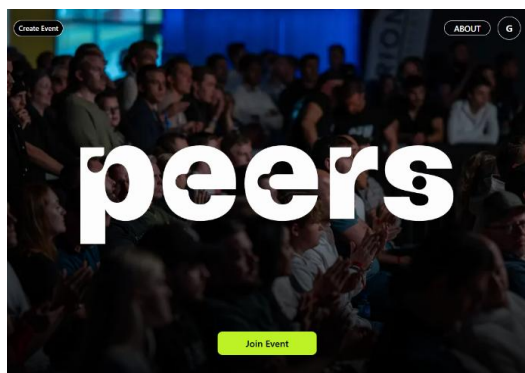


Figure 3: After clicking “New Peers event”

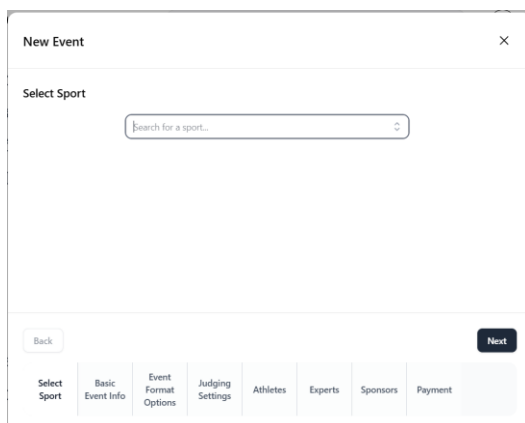
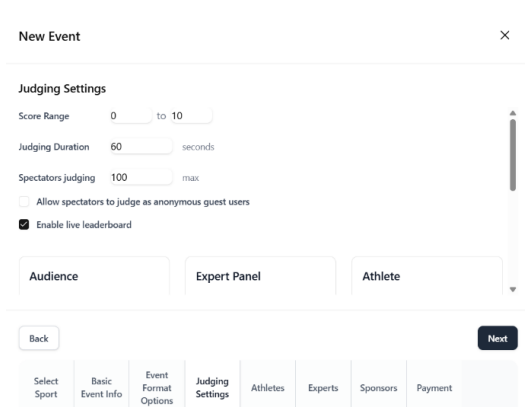


Figure 4: When clicking “Judging settings”



From figure 4 we can see that setting up an event is not the easiest, and some of the forms to fill can be complex. Based on this, the task given to us is to: *Make a solution that makes onboarding simpler and more intuitive for creating or setting up an event.*

2. Tools used for Google Sprint Design.

- Miro for planning a Phase.
- Discord for communication.
- GitHub for version control.
- TypeScript for frontend.
- React for frontend.
- Python for backend.

Figure 5: Visualization of our Google Sprint Design process made by Gemini AI.

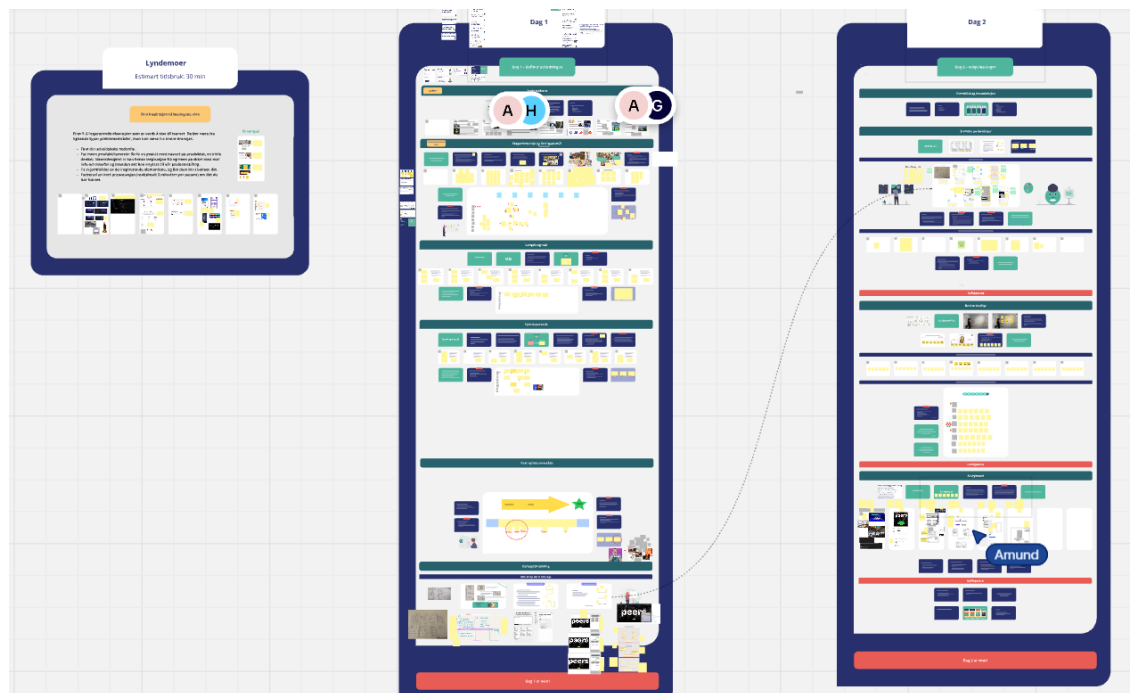


3. Planning Phase

3.1. Miro Board:

In our group, Miro was used for the design sprint. The Miro board planning phase consists of two days “working alone, together”. Figure 6 visualizes the two days or work in summary, where each rectangle corresponds to one of the days (left day one, right day two). Miro board were used together while we were using Discord for communication. In addition, we had one Chief who was responsible for making all important decisions, A facilitator who was responsible for the time and processes and an Expert (Peers) who contributes with knowledge about the problem.

Figure 6: Shows the whole Miro Board.



3.2. Day 1 of planning Phase.

The first day of sprint planning consisted of multiple iterative steps, including:

1. Icebreakers
2. Expert interview and HMW- questions
3. Long-term goal
4. Sprint questions
5. Mapping and focus area
6. Lightning demos
7. Concept sketching

3.2.1 Ice Breakers

The first step of our design sprint was to get to know each other better and literally break the ice between us. The icebreaker was done some days in advance to have it ready before everything else, and we could just quickly go through it. In the icebreaker, we made each of our own slides to describe our names, an Icebreaker sentence, inner weather report, favourite ice cream and previous experience. By doing this, we got to know each other better, making it easier to communicate and making people a lot more comfortable.

[illegible]

For the Expert interview and HWM questions, we had to do some work in advance, where each member had to watch an expert interview video and listen. While each member was listening to the interview, we individually wrote HMW post-it notes questions and put them in our respective workbooks /boards (Figure 8). HWM is a design thinking technique used to reframe a problem into open questions that works as a bridge from defining ideas, so we can generate many possible solutions without locking onto one solution too early [2]. When writing the question, we followed the structure of “how might we + action + for + user + so that + desired outcome” while also making sure that they were not too narrow or too broad.

[illegible]

The diagram illustrates the four layers of a cloud architecture stack, represented by four blue rectangular blocks arranged horizontally. From left to right, the blocks are labeled: 'UI', 'cost-efficiency', 'Backend', and 'AI'.

After pre-work preparation, doing all of what we described above, we moved on to the voting process. Where each respective member picked 2-3 of their HWM questions and put them into the big whiteboard. The notes were organized into categories in silence and put under their corresponding blue notes (Figure 9). When the organization was completed, each member found their respective red dots and voted on the post it notes that would have the biggest impact. The notes with the highest votes were put into the light blue board on the right-hand side.

3.2.3 Long-term goal.

For the long-term goal, we defined an optimistic “in two years” vision of what success should look like for Peers if onboarding and event creation becomes simple and intuitive. Each member wrote 2-3 statements on post-it’s and we reviewed them in silence before voting. We used dot-voting to select the most motivating and clear vision: red dots were regular votes, and the chief (høvding) used the green dot as the deciding vote. The chosen long-term goal is shown in Figure 10.

Figure 10: The chief chosen goal.



Figure 11: The whole process of Longterm Goal.



3.2.4 Sprint Questions

After agreeing on the long-term goal, we turned our biggest “risk assumptions” into sprint questions (that decide if the concept will fail or succeed). We wrote them individually in silence and kept them “super pessimistic”, starting with “Can we” so they become testable through the prototype and user reactions (Figure 11). Then we dot-voted to narrow it down, where the red dots were normal votes, and chief votes (green dot) made the final decision. The sprint questions that were decided to guide the sprint are shown in figure 12, while figure 13 shows the other process during the development of the spring questions.

Figure 12: The votes that were decided on.

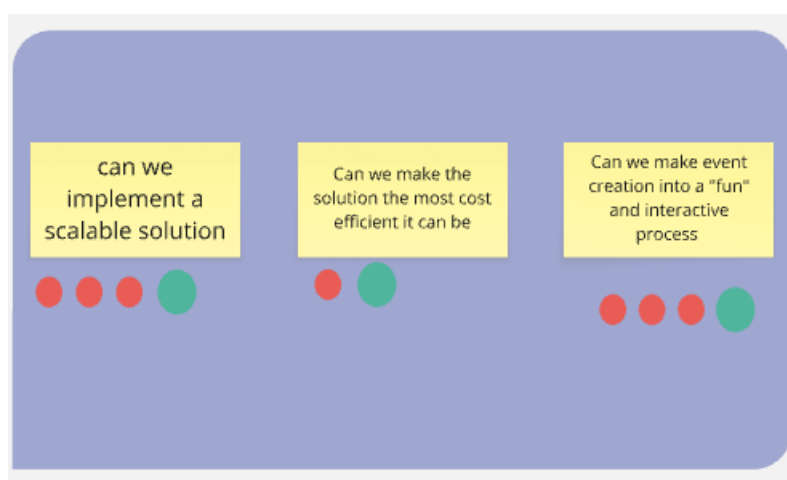
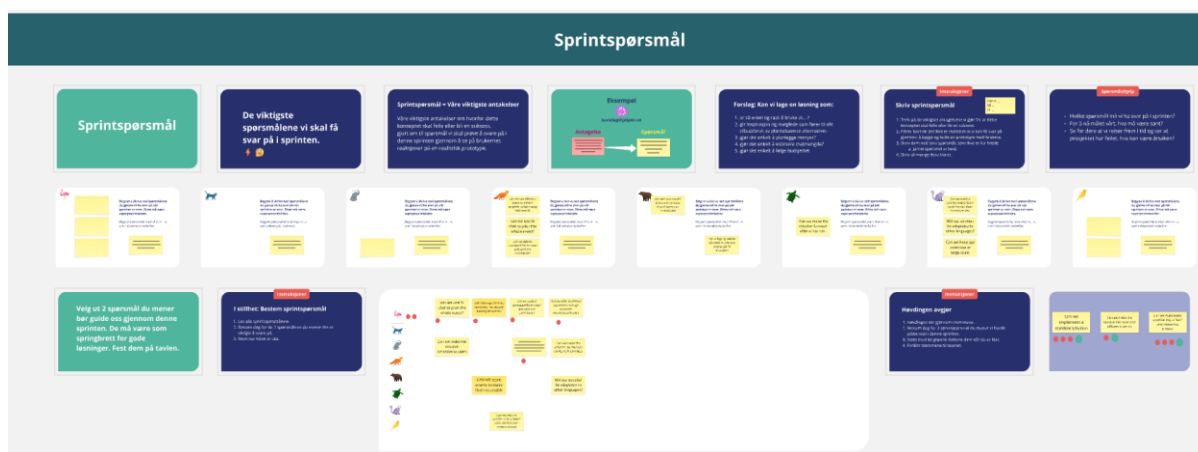


Figure 13: The whole process of Sprint questions.



3.2.5 Mapping and Focus-area:

To identify where the biggest problems in the current solution happen, we created a simple user journey map for our target group: and event/contest organizer. The map followed the organizer from first hearing/discovering about Peers, to learning the product and setting up

and event (learn) and finally using Peers during the event (Use), with the overall goal of a seamless onboarding experience.

Next, we placed out the top five HMW- notes (How might we) onto the step in the journey where they naturally belong. We used dot-voting on HMW to visualize where friction is highest. The votes clustered mainly around the early event-creation phase, especially when users:

- Realize event setup requires many steps,
- Struggle to understand event formats (Ranking vs battle)
- Need clearer guidance/explanation
- And find adding athletes/participants manually time-consuming.

Based on where most HMW and votes appeared, we selected the focus area for the sprint: Improving the onboarding + event creation flow (from “create event” to configure format/rules” and adding athletes). Finally, the Chief (green dot) decided which sprint questions would guide the sprint, resulting in a clear focus on: Making event creation feel “fun” and interactive while still being intuitive and efficient shown in Figure 14, while Figure 15 shows the other focus suggestions.

Figure 14: What the chief voted on.

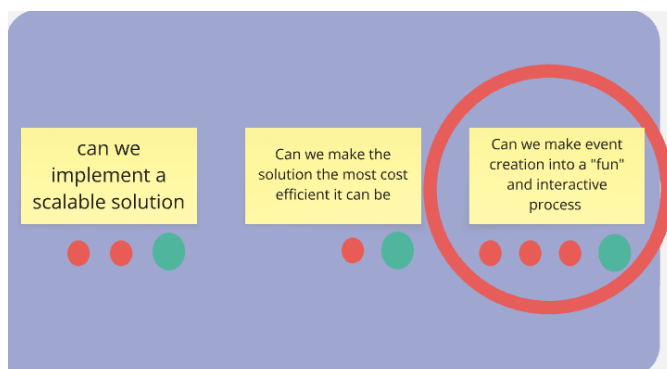


Figure 15: The whole mapping and focus-Area

concept sketches that could be evaluated fairly in the concept gallery, without the presenter “selling” the idea.

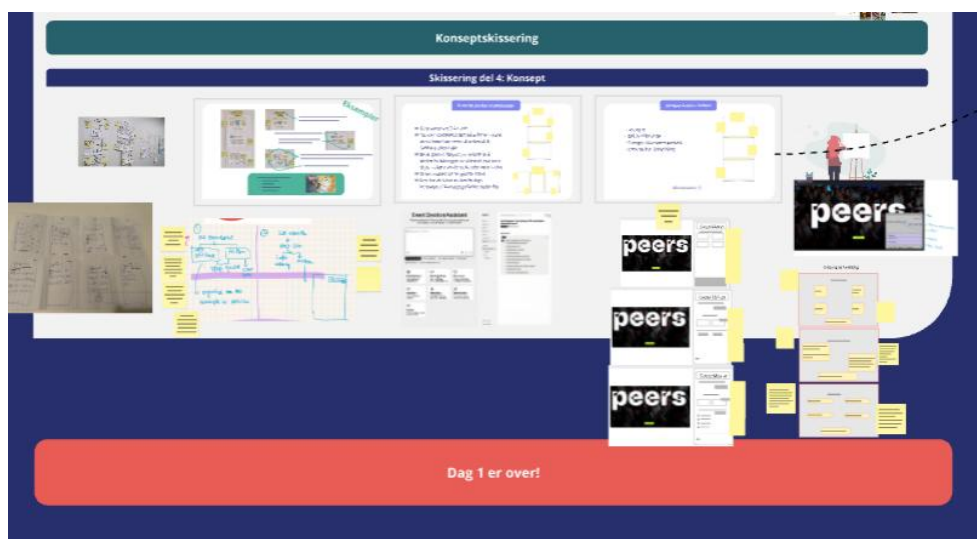
We followed the format and rules for a concept sketch:

- The sketches had to be anonymous, so roles/titles wouldn’t influence the selection.
- They had to be self-explanatory (no live pitching), with clear descriptions (“narrator voice”) written on sticky notes.
- The sketches did not need to be perfect, but the wording and flow mattered, and the story should be read from left to right.
- We aimed for a catchy title to make the concept easy to remember.

Not everyone had pen and paper available, so some concept sketches were made digitally.

The important part was that each concept still followed the same “three screen story” structure and included enough explanation to be understood on its own. The result is shown in Figure 17.

Figure 17: The whole concept sketching process.



3.3 Day 2 of Planning Phase.

Day 2 picked up from where we finished off in day 1, and consisted of:

1. Concept gallery.
2. User test flow

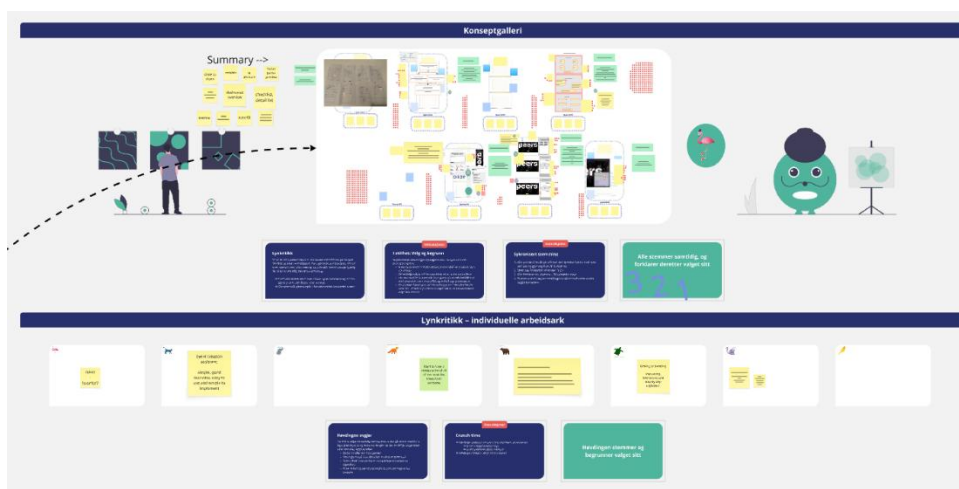
3. Storyboard

3.3.1 Concept-gallery

The first initial step was that everyone had to find their concept sketches and put them into the concept gallery as shown in figure 18 below. Afterwards each member had to look at the sprint questions (Figure 12) and place the dots in silence on the ideas; we liked the best. If there were concepts that someone did not fully understand, they could write it under as a question and get it answered later.

When we finished the red dot voting phase, we went through all questions and concepts, so everyone had a good overview of each concept. In silence everyone found their corresponding green dot (except the chief) and voted on a countdown of 3 on the concepts they liked the most. During the vote, everyone had to write a note about why and they liked the concept. In the end, the chief had to make the executive's decision to place their two votes: (1) on the main concept (2) on an extra function, while also explaining their reasons behind it for the team.

Figure 18: Concept-Gallery



3.3.2 User Test Flows

Given that we have now decided what concept to test, we must decide on how the flow of the user tests should be: what should be in the prototype. Everyone spent 6 minutes making their 6-step versions of the user test flow for the winning concept. For this segment, our winning test flow is shown in Figure 19. Figure 20 shows all the different user flow steps made by all of us. Figure 19: Most voted for User test flow

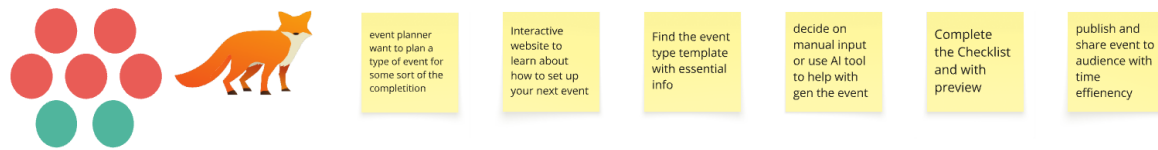
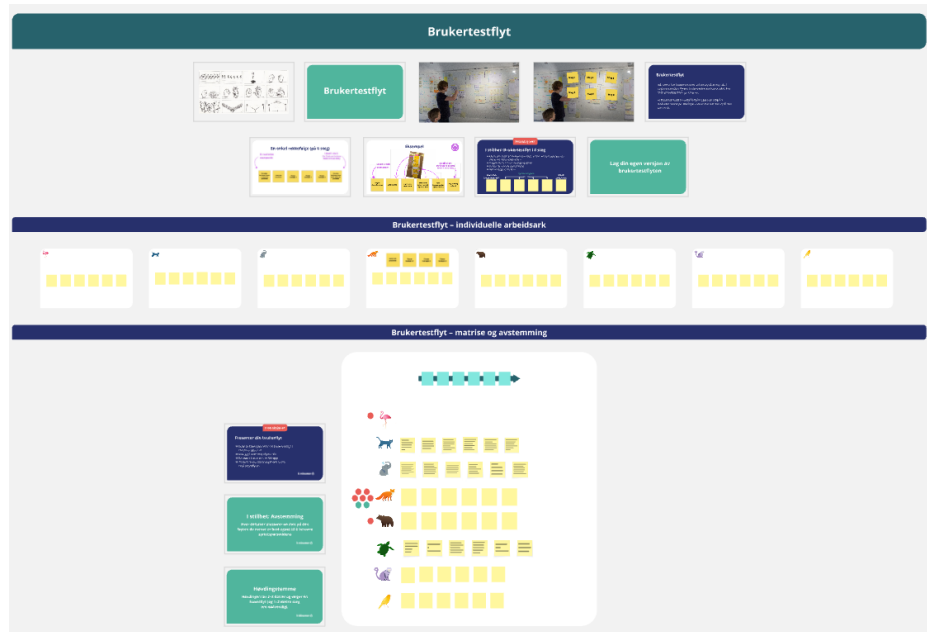


Figure 20: The whole User test flow segment.



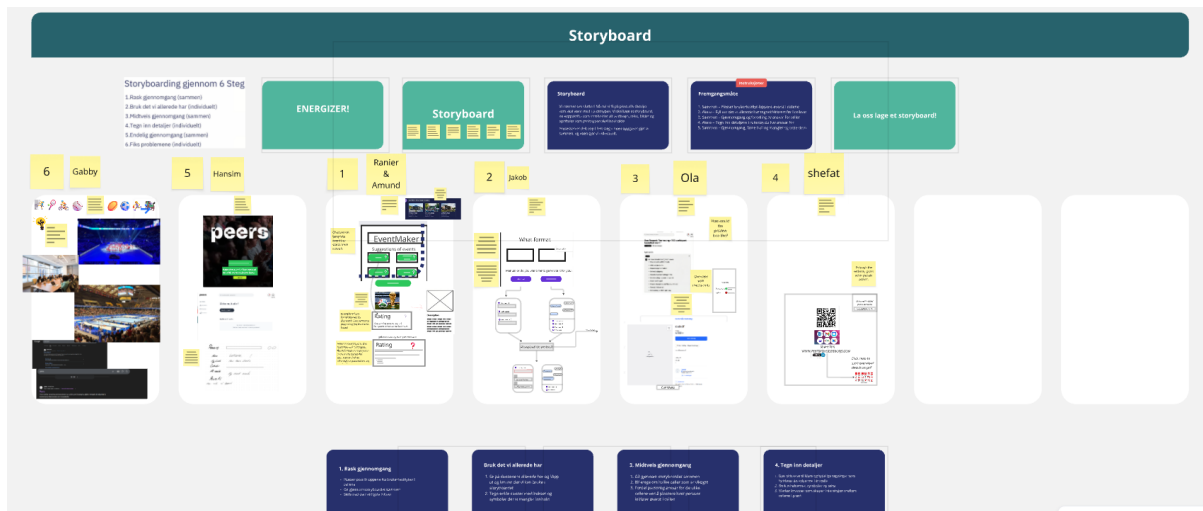
3.3.3 Storyboard

The storyboard was built upon the user test flow, where we put each of the post-it notes in one workboard each. This was the recipe that would include everything about design, text, and symbols which the prototype is going to include. The process was split into 5 steps, where some of the tasks are done together and some are done individually:

1. Together – place the user flow test notes at the top of the cells.
2. Individually – fill in what we previously drew/sketched into the cells.
3. Together – go through and give each member one responsibility
4. Individually – Finn in the cells each member got.
5. Together – Go through and fill in the missing gaps so it is complete.

After doing all of this we went through the storyboard together and put blue post-its wherever there was a gap and then we went through and solved the issues. The finalized storyboard is shown in Figure 21.

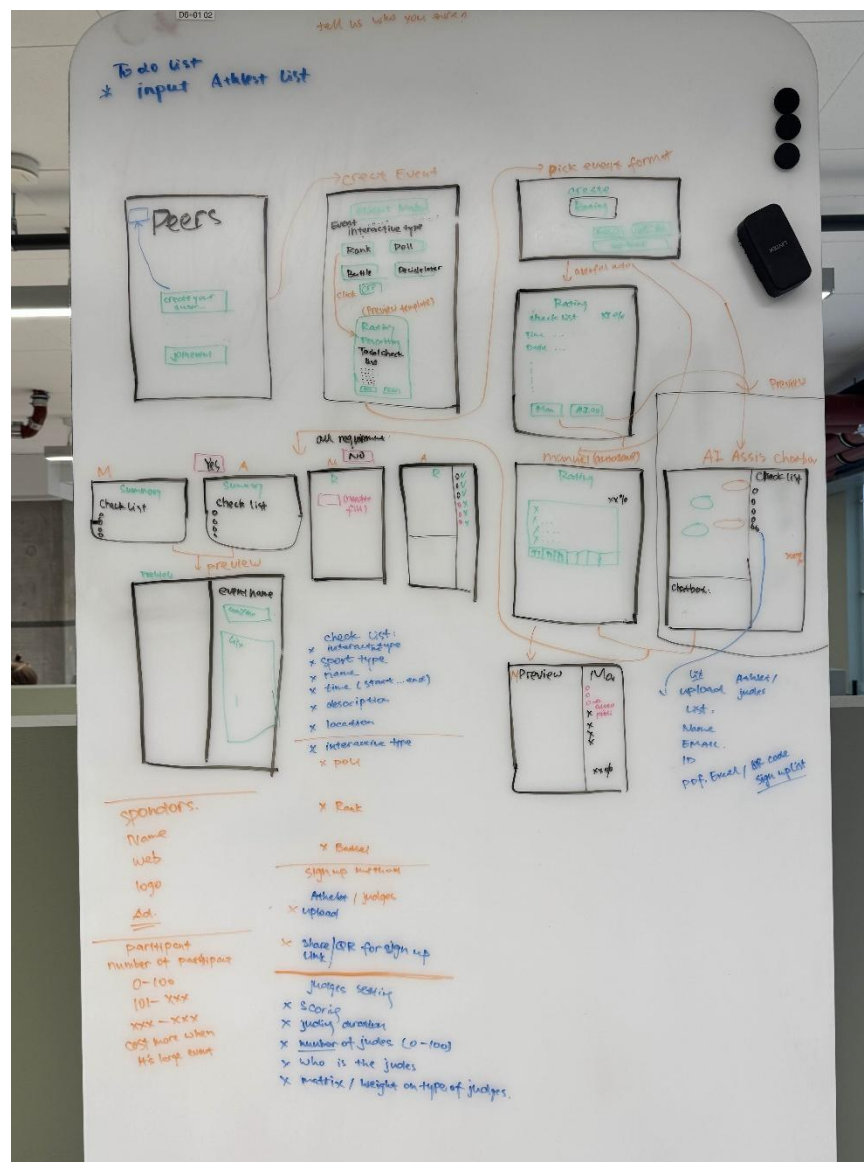
Figure 21: Storyboard



4. Prototype – Day 3

The goal for the day was to create a prototype that demonstrated the entire journey from the moment a user enters the site until they complete the onboarding process. Figure 22 illustrates how the intended user journey should look when accessing the platform.

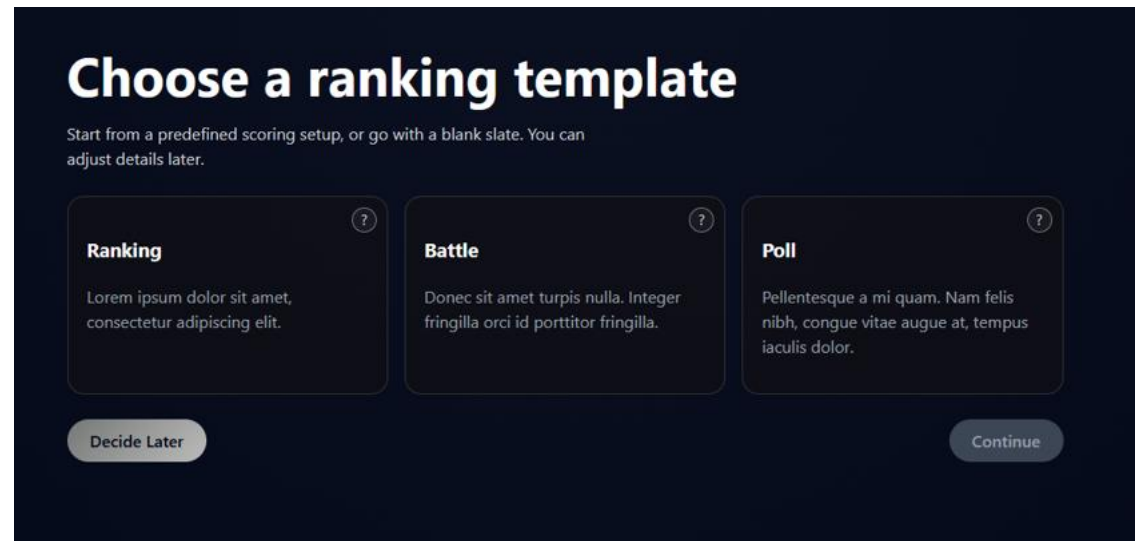
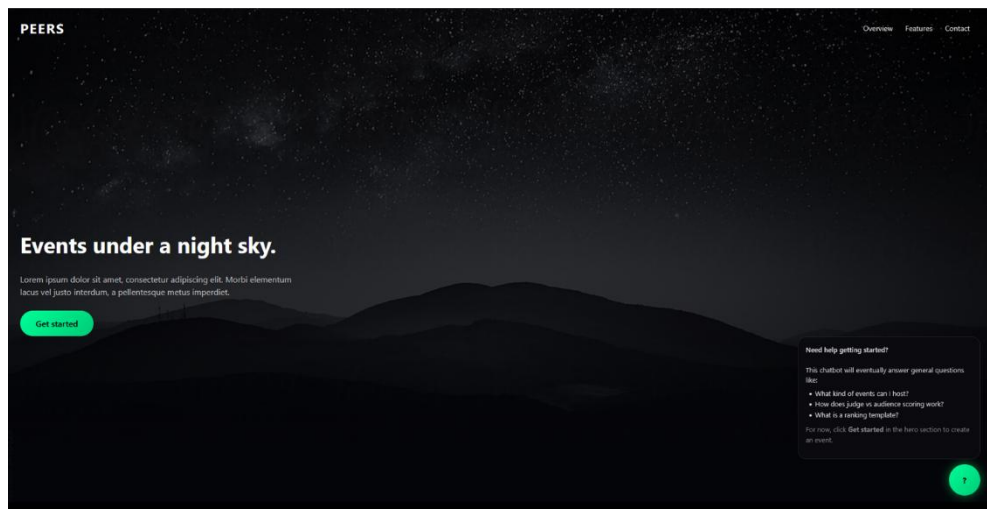
Figure 22: Visualizing the prototype



Since we were a team of seven, we divided the work into smaller groups with responsibility for different areas. One group focused directly on building the prototype and designing the full experience based on the results from the design sprint, from the initial landing page to the final step of the onboarding. The remaining team members, who were not involved in the front-end development, contributed through supporting tasks. Some conducted backend research, while others worked on developing the questions for the user's questionnaire.

Even though we had individual responsibilities, the collaboration flowed well. We frequently supported each other across tasks to ensure everyone had insight into all aspects of the work but also giving another perspective on the task at hand. We also held regular check-ins to update the team on our progress and align the next steps.

The images below show the user journey and the different steps the user goes through before they can finalize their event.



← Back to templates

How do you want to set up your Battle event?

You can use a standard form, or answer a few high-level questions and let the assistant suggest values.

Uploaded Files

Event Summary.txt

+ Add Another File

Extracted Data

Venue: Grand Convention Center

Date & Time: 2024-03-15 18:00

Sponsor: TechCorp International

Event Name: Annual Innovation Summit

Event Type: Conference

Participants: 250

AI assisted setup

Describe your event. The assistant will ask follow-up questions and suggest values.

Manual setup

Use a structured form to specify values step by step.

← Back

Manual setup

Fill out your event details. Required fields must be completed before continuing.

Event name Required

Redbull Cliff Diving

Event type Required

Cliff Diving

Number of contestants Required

30

Scoring (audience vs judges)

Audience 50% - Judges 50%

Venue

Event date and time range

Start

dd / mm / yyyy , -- : --

End

dd / mm / yyyy , -- : --

Sponsor (optional)

Rules (optional)

Live preview

Name: Redbull Cliff Diving

Type: Cliff Diving

Contestants: 30

Scoring: Audience 50% - Judges 50%

Venue: Not set

Date and time: Not set

Sponsor: Not set

Audience limit: Not set

Rules: Not set

AI Assisted Setup

Describe your event in one or two sentences, and I will help you capture the key details.

I am hosting a Cliff Diving Contest called 'Redbull Cliff Diving' sponsored by Redbull. We will have 30 contestants and it will be hosted on the Oslo Opera.

What category does this event belong to?

Cliff diving

Good progress. You can tell me about the timing, rules, audience limit, scoring, or continue whenever you prefer.

We want an audience limit of 1000. The scoring will be done by the audience only. The event will happen June 20th 2026 14:00 to 20:00.

Good progress. You can tell me about the rules, or continue whenever you prefer.

Write something...

Send

Required

✓ Name

Redbull Cliff Diving

✓ Type

Cliff diving

✓ Contestants

30

Optional

• Scoring

audience

• Venue

Oslo Opera

• Date and time

20th June 14:00 to 20:00

• Sponsor

Redbull

• Rules

• Audience limit

1000

Continue

Event summary

Review the event configuration before saving it.

Redbull Cliff Diving

20th June

Oslo Opera

Event Info

Type: Cliff diving

Participants: 30

Scoring: Audience

Sponsor: Redbull

Audience limit: 1000

Rules

[placeholder]

Back

Confirm & save

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5. Interview and results.

The next phase was interviewing 5 different people and asking them questions about our prototype. These questions were:

- What was your first impression when you opened the landing page?
- Did you understand what the service does?
- How did you experience the interaction with the AI assistant?
- Did the chatbot feel helpful and relevant for the task?
- Did it feel easier than how you would normally set up an event?
- Did the AI feel tailored to your needs?
- Was anything confusing or unclear during the process?
- Did you trust the service/Peers Event based on the test?
- Would you personally want to use this service in the future?
- Would you consider paying for it / subscribing?

We used a scale from 1 to 5, where 1 was very negative to 5 being very positive and got the average for each question when gathering the results.

Figure 23 shows the results gathered from the different users and how they scored each question.

User 1	User 2	User 3	User 4	User 5	Avg	Question
4	4	3	4	3	3.6	1. What was your first impression when you opened the landing page?
2	4	4	4	3	3.4	2. Did you understand what the service does?
2	2	5	3	4	3.2	3. How did you experience the interaction with the AI assistant?
4	4	5	4	4	4.2	4. Did the chatbot feel helpful and relevant for the task?
4	3	4	4	3	3.6	5. Did it feel easier than how you would normally set up an event?
4	5	5	3	5	4.4	6. Did the AI feel tailored to your needs?
5	4	4	2	3	3.6	7. Was anything confusing or unclear during the process?
4	4	5	2	4	3.8	8. Did you trust the service/Peers Event based on the test?
4	4	4	4	4	4.0	9. Would you personally want to use this service in the future?
1	3	3	1	3	2.2	10. Would you consider paying for it / subscribing?

The users also got the opportunity to add a comment after each question, so that we could get a better understanding behind the score given.

Figure 24 shows the commentary that were given by the different users.

Shifat	User 2	1	Likes the design, thinks it looks professional, and the colors look good.
Shifat	User 2	2	Gives “night event” vibes → makes him think more about parties, like night events.
Shifat	User 2	3	Didn’t understand the difference between Battle, Poll, etc. Also didn’t know there was a “Decide later” button.
Shifat	User 2	4	Liked that there was an AI; manual setup was too boring and took more time.
Shifat	User 2	5	The AI was helpful but complained that it didn’t understand anything and was a bit difficult to work with. However, liked that there was
Shifat	User 2	6	Manual setup was okay, but he would rather use the AI, and it would have been much easier if the AI worked properly.
Shifat	User 2	7	It wasn’t fully clear, but the overall experience was good.
Shifat	User 2	8	Trusted the process, but not the AI because it didn’t work that well.
Shifat	User 2	9	Would use it himself.
Shifat	User 2	10	Would probably not pay for a subscription because people don’t often create events, but maybe a maximum of 100–150 NOK
Ranier	User 3	1	Empty, big room, doesn’t give you any impression of what it’s about. – 2 on the prototype, 3 on the original page.
Ranier	User 3	2	From looking at the page you don’t really pick up what they do. With the original page, it was a bit more understanding because of the background
Ranier	User 3	3	Easy, you understand what happens next.
Ranier	User 3	4	Yes, because it does what it’s supposed to do for me.
Ranier	User 3	5	Yes, it feels time-efficient. I like the checklist feature.
Ranier	User 3	6	Yes, it gives me options, feels time-efficient, and gets the job done.
Ranier	User 3	7	Confusion around the Import File part — shouldn’t that come after choosing whether you want assistance or manual setup?
Ranier	User 3	8	Gives a professional impression.
Ranier	User 3	9	Yes, because it seems time-efficient. Automated, which can save me time and gives me a clear overview.
Ranier	User 3	10	Not for small events, but for larger events the willingness is higher.

Results

The user testing of our prototype showed an overall positive reception toward the concept of an AI-assisted onboarding flow in Peers Event. Users consistently described the solution as time-efficient, helpful, and professionally presented, with strong appreciation for features like the checklist and the live overview. The average scores across the ten questions landed mostly between 3.5 and 4.5, indicating that the prototype generally felt intuitive, supportive, and more streamlined than manual setup—especially for users who valued automation and clearer structure. Most testers said they would use the service again, and several highlighted that the design looked professional, and the AI assistant made the process easier when it worked as intended.

However, the feedback also revealed several improvement areas. Many users struggled to understand the purpose of the landing page and felt it didn’t clearly communicate what Peers does. The AI wasn’t functional and therefore led some testers to trust the overall process but *not* the AI itself. Components like “Battle” and “Poll,” the Import File flow, and the overview section also caused confusion for some users. Willingness to pay was low, with most participants saying they would not subscribe monthly, though some were open to one-time payments for larger events. Overall, the test results confirm strong potential in the concept, while showing that clarity, AI accuracy, and onboarding flow need refinement.

Reflection

- Did you find answers to the sprint questions?

Yes. Based on the feedback we received from users, it seems we are moving in the right direction. Many described the process as “fun”, more interactive, and more intuitive than the current onboarding solution. The insights also confirmed that our concept has strong potential to be both cost-efficient and scalable. While the prototype is still early, the sprint helped us validate the core assumptions, and we expect to gain deeper insight once we begin developing the backend and refining the AI functionality.

- Could you have done anything differently?

We could have polished the prototype further, especially by adding certain details we already know will be part of the final solution. Some users were distracted by missing elements, which influenced their feedback and scoring. With a more complete prototype, the interviews might have produced even richer insights and a more accurate evaluation of our concept.

Another improvement point relates to user interviews. Due to the limited timeframe, we mainly interviewed students. Ideally, we would have included participants who work directly with event planning or represent the type of users Peers aims to attract. This could have provided more relevant and industry-specific feedback.

- What were you particularly satisfied with?

We were especially satisfied with how well our prototype reflected the concept we developed during the first two days of the design sprint. Even though the task felt overwhelming due to the time constraints and the complexity of the solution, we collaborated efficiently and managed to create a prototype that clearly communicates our vision. The teamwork, structure, and alignment throughout the sprint were strong points for us.

- What would you do differently if you were to conduct a similar sprint again?

Now that we understand the Design Sprint process, we would be much more efficient during the early stages. A significant part of the sprint was spent understanding the framework and organizing ourselves, rather than focusing purely on the problem. This slowed us down and may have impacted the final output.

It would also have been preferable to have done this physically together, since we had some issues with working out a concept virtually. There might have been some ideas that didn't get brought to light because they didn't get to visualize in a good way.

References:

1. "Miro (Collaboration Platform)." 2023. Wikipedia. June 14, 2023.
[https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Miro_\(collaboration_platform\)](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Miro_(collaboration_platform)).
2. Interaction Design Foundation. 2016. "How Might We." The Interaction Design Foundation. November 22, 2016. <https://www.interaction-design.org/literature/topics/how-might-we>.